

Pastry Station Orientation

Owner: Aiko Tanaka (Pastry Lead) Summary: Scales, allergen trays, proofer and oven schedule for new pastry cooks.

Core Rules (Do Not Change)

- Everything is weighed in grams. Calibrate the scale every Monday.
- **Purple trays** are for nut and allergen items only.
- Oven schedule: laminated doughs first (6 AM), then cakes, then cookies.
- Proofing settings are posted on the proofing door — follow the posted card, not memory.

Station Setup and Tools

- Tools at hand before mixing: digital scale, micro-scale for leavening/spice, bench scraper, thermometers (probe and IR), timers, sheet pans, parchment, racks, plastic wrap, pan spray.
- Ingredients staged: flour, sugar, salt, leaveners, dairy, eggs, chocolates, nuts (on purple trays only), spices.
- Equipment on and checked: stand mixers locked, oven preheating and vent clear, proofing powered with water reservoir filled, blast chiller available for rapid cooling.
- Labeling: use product name, prep cook initials, time, and "ALLERGEN: [type]" if any. Use purple labels for nut items when available.

Scale Use and Monday Calibration

Everything we do depends on accurate weights. Bad scale = bad bake.

1) Verify both scales are clean and level on the stainless worktable. 2) Check battery indicator; replace if low. Keep spare batteries in the top drawer. 3) Warm-up: turn on, let sit 5 minutes. 4) Zero with empty pan or container. 5) Calibrate the scale every Monday:

1. Gather certified calibration weights (1,000 g and 100 g).
2. Enter CAL mode per scale's front-panel instructions.
3. Place weights as prompted. Confirm readouts match exactly.
4. If off by more than 1 g, repeat once. If still off, pull from service, tag "DO NOT USE," notify Aiko Tanaka.

6) During service: re-zero between ingredients. If readings drift, power-cycle, re-zero, and verify with the 100 g test weight.

What to do if:

- Scale dies mid-batch: stop, mark bowl “HOLD,” replace batteries or swap to backup, re-weigh components you can, and note on batch sheet.
- Scale can’t hold tare: move to a stable surface, clean feet, re-zero. If still unstable, tag out and notify Aiko Tanaka.

Allergen Controls: Purple Trays Only

We protect guests and the line.

- **Purple trays** are for nut and allergen items only. Never use purple trays for non-allergen items.
- Store nuts, nut flours, and nut-topped bakes on purple trays with fitted covers.
- Tools for allergen work: dedicate a purple-handled spatula and scoop. Wash, rinse, sanitize, and air-dry before and after use.
- Mix nut items after non-allergen doughs when possible to reduce airborne contact.
- Rack placement: allergen trays always on the lowest shelves to prevent drip/crumb fall.
- Label clearly: “ALLERGEN: NUTS” or specific allergen.
- If a purple tray is missing/dirty: stop, clean or find a clean purple tray. Do not “borrow” a regular tray.

What to do if:

- Allergen item touched a non-allergen tray/tool: treat the non-allergen as contaminated. Rewash/sanitize tools; replate the allergen item onto a clean purple tray; discard contaminated non-allergen if contact was direct.
- Guest allergy order comes in: confirm mise was produced on purple trays and stored correctly; pull from purple rack with clean, dedicated tools.

Proofer Use

- Proofer settings are posted on the proofer door — follow the posted card, not memory.
- Fill water reservoir; confirm steam function if required on posted card.
- Load trays with 1-inch spacing between pans for airflow.
- Rotate pans halfway through long proofs unless the card says “No rotate.”
- Keep door closed as much as possible to hold humidity and temperature.
- If condensation drips, crack door for 20 seconds, wipe sill, then close.

What to do if:

- Proofer card is missing: do not guess. Stop. Ask Aiko Tanaka or use the verified laminated backup in the pastry binder.
- Proofer runs hot/cold: verify with probe thermometer placed on middle rack; adjust per posted tolerance. If still off, tag "OUT OF SPEC" and switch to ambient proof with time/temperature extended as needed; notify Aiko Tanaka.

Oven Schedule and Loading

Oven schedule: laminated doughs first (6 AM), then cakes, then cookies.

Use this sequence to keep butter integrity and manage carryover heat.

Product Type	Load Time	Oven Temp (°F)	Rack Position	Notes
Laminated doughs	6:00 AM	375–400	Upper-middle, spaced	Load into a fully preheated dry oven; steam by spritzing door if required.
Cakes	After lams	325–350	Middle	No fan/high fan off if convection; avoid opening door first 50% of bake.
Cookies	After cakes	325–350	Middle-lower	Rotate pans at 60% time for even color.

- Preheat at least 20 minutes. Verify with IR thermometer on stone/steel, not just the display.
- Stage next load on speed rack with labels.
- Use timers for each rack. One timer per product.

What to do if:

- Behind schedule at 6 AM: prioritize laminated doughs; delay cakes 10–15 minutes rather than rush lamination.
- Uneven color: check fan setting and pan spacing; rotate earlier next batch.
- Burning bottoms: double-pan or move down 25°F and extend time.

Cooling, Holding, and Food Safety

- Hot to cold: cool baked goods from oven-safe hot to 70°F within 2 hours, then to 41°F within 4 hours when refrigeration is required (custards, cheesecakes, pastry cream, curds).
- Use the blast chiller for high-moisture or high-risk items. Vent lids, shallow pans (no more than 2 in deep), rack spacing for airflow.
- Room-temp holding: dry cookies, plain cakes, and laminated items without cream hold covered at ambient; keep off the oven to avoid butter weeping.
- Cold holding: dairy fillings and icings at or below 41°F. Scoop with clean utensils; no bare-hand contact.

Opening and Closing Checklists

Opening 1) Wash hands; set up sani bucket (200–400 ppm quat or 50–100 ppm chlorine). 2) Scales on; warm-up and quick-check with 100 g weight. 3) Preheat oven; fill and set proofer per posted card. 4) Pull butter to temper per production plan. 5) Stage ingredients and tools; set purple trays for allergens. 6) Start laminated dough bakes at 6 AM.

Closing 1) Cool, wrap, and label all products. Dairy-based items to reach 41°F. 2) Deep clean mixers, benches, sheeter, scales; air-dry. 3) Purple trays washed last, then sanitized and dried; store in allergen zone. 4) Empty proofer reservoir; wipe dry; leave door cracked. 5) Log any out-of-spec equipment; notify Aiko Tanaka.

Quality Targets and Troubleshooting

- Laminated: visible layers, no grease puddling, even mahogany color.
- Cakes: flat tops unless specified, crumb set, skewer clean with a few moist crumbs.
- Cookies: uniform spread, no raw center, edges set.

If targets aren't met:

- Underbaked: return to oven in 2–3 minute increments.
- Overbaked/dry: note batch, adjust next bake time down 2–5 minutes or lower temp 15–25°F.
- Spreading too much: chill dough 20–30 minutes; check butter temp; verify flour weight on the scale.